

MICHAEL SOLLA

Apopka, FL | 407-592-7049 | michael.solla@gmail.com [linkedin.com/in/michael-solla](https://www.linkedin.com/in/michael-solla)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Leader in AWS Cloud Engineering and Solutions Architecture with a decade of experience designing, securing, and optimizing enterprise-scale cloud environments. Expert in DevSecOps, containerized architectures (ECS/Fargate), and full-stack observability. Blends deep technical engineering with security expertise—partnering cross-functionally to drive cloud modernization, vulnerability management, strict compliance, and AI-driven operational efficiency.

CORE COMPETENCIES

DevSecOps and Cloud Strategy: AWS (ECS, Networking, IAM, Serverless), Virtualization and Container Migration, CI/CD Architecture, Platform Engineering. | **Security and Compliance:** Vulnerability Management, Automated Guardrails, AWS WAF, CloudFront, Edge Security, Threat Mitigation. | **Automation and AI:** GenAI Strategy, AI-Driven Tooling, Pipeline Modernization, Scripting (Python, Bash, PowerShell). | **Systems Administration:** Cross-Platform Support (Linux, Windows, Mac), FinOps Cost Efficiency.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ASURION / UBREAKIFIX | 2016 – 2026

Senior Manager, Software Engineering (DevOps & Platform) | 2021 – 2026

- **Security and Compliance Pipeline:** Transformed the vulnerability management strategy into a continuous security pipeline by integrating Brinqa, CodeQL, and Dependabot. Established automated policy-as-code guardrails for proactive monitoring, full-stack observability, and strict compliance.
- **Strategic AI Integration and Architecture:** Architected a serverless AWS Lambda pipeline to integrate user intake forms with Large Language Models, automatically refining unstructured requests into standardized Jira tickets. Additionally piloted Jira RoVo to connect Confluence documentation with AI search, laying the groundwork for enterprise knowledge retrieval.
- **CI/CD Velocity and Platform Engineering:** Pioneered the transition from shared GitHub Action runners to a custom AWS CodeBuild architecture. Reduced build times by 75 percent, from 120 seconds to under 30 seconds, and optimized costs by shifting to a serverless execution model.
- **Operational Resilience & Risk Mitigation:** Successfully mitigated a critical delivery risk for the company's flagship revenue platform. Maintained 100% project velocity during the Lead Architect's absence by **restructuring roles** and upskilling key engineers to eliminate single points of failure.
- **Deployment Standardization and Governance:** Directed the **departmental adoption** of Infrastructure-as-Code (IaC) to eliminate manual configuration drift. Standardized the team's deployment patterns using **AWS CDK**, ensuring repeatable, compliant infrastructure delivery across all engineering projects.
- **Platform Modernization ("Next Gen"):** Led the multi-year architectural transformation from a legacy PHP monolith to a distributed, cloud-native ecosystem. This initiative modernized the revenue-critical platform, significantly improving system uptime, scalability, and **feature release velocity**.

- **Targeted FinOps Execution:** Partnered with Cloud Governance to execute a granular AWS audit; reduced monthly waste by rightsizing **ECS Fargate** auto-scaling policies and decommissioning "zombie" infrastructure (orphaned databases and idle EC2 sandboxes).

Manager, DevOps & Infrastructure | 2018 – 2021

- **Cloud Automation and CI/CD Leader:** Spearheaded the transition from manual deployments to an automated CI/CD ecosystem. Built and managed the company's **AWS CodePipeline** and **AWS CodeBuild** configurations from scratch, enabling rapid, repeatable deployments.
- **Containerization Strategy:** Architected and deployed the company's core **ECS** clusters, migrating legacy services into a modern containerized environment to improve scalability and efficiency.
- **M&A Technical Due Diligence:** Led the Asurion Acquisition technical review, delivering architecture & security audits that ensured a seamless, **zero-blocker closure**.
- **Strategic Cost Reduction:** Internalized infrastructure operations by terminating expensive external managed services (RightBrainNetworks), reducing monthly OpEx by an estimated 20%.
- **Hardware Lifecycle Strategy:** Executed a department-wide refresh to Apple Silicon (M1), leveraging alignment with AWS Graviton to save **20% per unit**.
- **Strategic Business Continuity (COVID-19):** Directed the immediate technical pivot to a "Remote-First" infrastructure during the 2020 pandemic. Migrated legacy container workloads to **AWS Fargate** to eliminate server maintenance, allowing the engineering team to sustain high deployment velocity despite the sudden workforce dispersion.

QA Manager | 2016 – 2018:

- Built the QA function from the ground up and standardized AWS S3 asset deployments, expanding leadership scope to establish the company's DevOps department.

PREVIOUS EXPERIENCE

- **Riptide Software** | Software Test Engineer | 2015 – 2016
- **Aon Hewitt** | Solution Quality Test Lead & Programmer Analyst | 2006 – 2015

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

Cloud & Systems: AWS (Expert: ECS, Fargate, S3, EC2, Lambda, IAM, API Gateway), Linux (RHEL), Windows Server, Docker. | **Automation & Scripting:** Bash, Python, Node.js, PowerShell. | **DevSecOps & CI/CD:** CodeBuild, CodePipeline, GitHub Actions, Dependabot, CodeQL, Infrastructure as Code principles (AWS CDK, CloudFormation, Terraform). | **Tools:** Notion, Jira, Roovo, Cursor, GitHub.

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate (2021–2024) | **AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner** (2018–2024) | **GIAC Security Essentials (GSEC)** (2020–2024) | **A.S. Game Design** – Full Sail Real World Education (2005)